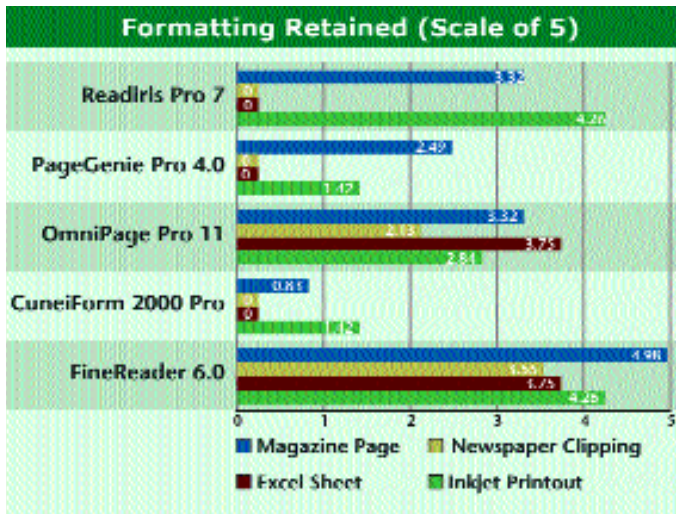
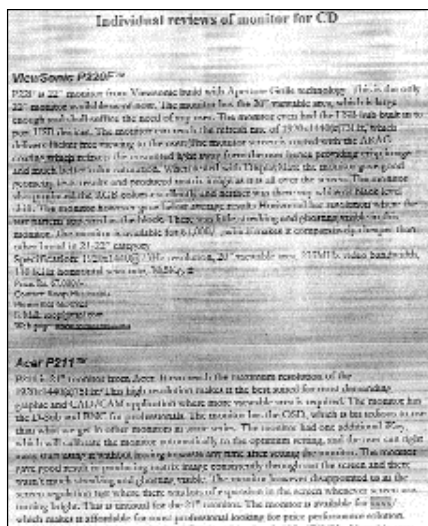




PageGenie Pro 4.0, on the other hand, fared poorly, logging a low 39.15 per cent accuracy. Compare this with its 92.92 per cent accuracy level in the inkjet printout test and it becomes clear that just changing the printing medium causes more than a 50 per cent drop in its character recognition capability.



Photocopied document

OmniPage Pro 11 did really well in retaining the layout and formatting, scoring an impressive 4.15 out of 5. Readiris Pro 7 and CuneiForm 2000 on the other hand did not retain any of the layout and formatting and scored nothing!

Fax document: Yet another stress test for the OCR engine is when it comes to reading fax copies. We made a fax copy of the inkjet printout; it had a lot of smudges and smears.

Here again, ABBYY FineReader 6.0 CE

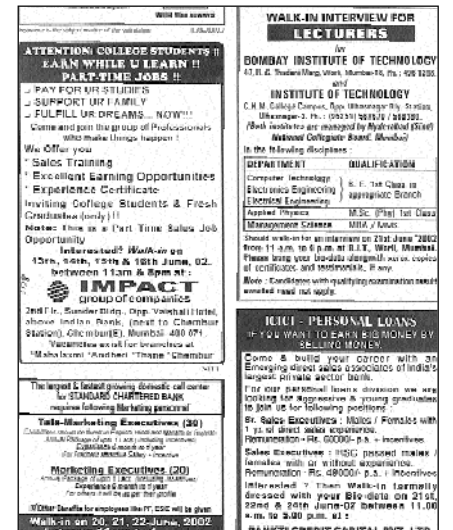
was the clear winner with an excellent score of 97.16 per cent accuracy. Although there were some minor errors in recognising characters such as '1' and '0', which were read as 'l' and 'Q' respectively, a score of over 90 per cent accuracy for a fax document is simply amazing. OmniPage too did well here, logging 95.75 per cent

accuracy. As for retaining formatting, OmniPage Pro 11 edged out FineReader 6.0 CE by a fair margin—it scored 2.49 against 1.66 for FineReader 6.0 CE.

Readiris Pro 7 returned disappointing results with an accuracy level of only 72.87 per cent. It, along with CuneiForm 2000, scored nil for formatting because there was absolutely no font formatting left. Every font had the same font type and size and it failed to retain even simple formatting like underlines, bold text and italics text!

Newspaper clipping: OCR-ing a newspaper is one of the most troublesome tasks. The varied formatting, fonts, thin paper and poor print quality make it very difficult for an OCR software to recognise the text.

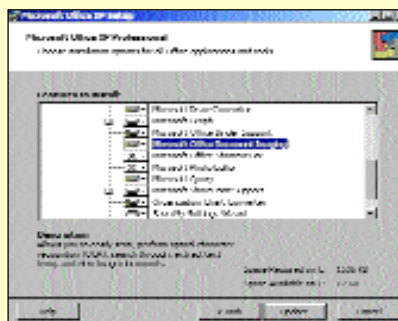
The newspaper clipping we used for the test had text in the standard two-column layout. Plus there were logos, reverse fonts (white on black) and highlights. There was a lot of smudging between fonts, with fonts getting mixed



Newspaper clipping

OCR with Office XP

Microsoft Office XP includes a separate program called Office Document Imaging. With this program you can

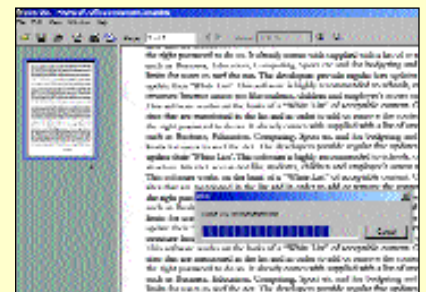


Installing Office Document Imaging

quickly and easily convert a scanned document into text with the optical character recognition (OCR) command.

To access the program, insert the Office XP CD. Select the Add/Remove option and navigate to Office Shared features. Here, select the Office Document Imaging

option and continue with the installation process. Once this feature is installed, go



Office XP's built-in OCR engine does a fairly decent job

to **Start > Programs > Microsoft Office Tools** and click on **Document Imaging**. Open the text document which you have scanned, or select **Scan New Document** if you wish to directly scan it into this program. Now click **File > Recognize text using OCR**. This text can then be directly transferred to Microsoft Word.